

SAMUEL LATONA

ARCHITECT / 3D GENERALIST / VISUALISATION DIRECTOR

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https://www.upwork.com/freelancers/~01bd532f83dd4856a11?mp_source=share

EDUCATION

B.Sc.Architectural Engineering Technology

University Studies

CONTACT

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CORE SKILLS

3D Product Design

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3D Character Modelling

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3D Product Animation

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Character Animation

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3D Game Trailer Production

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Rigging & Skinning

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VFX / SFX Integration

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Industrial Product Design

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3D Printing

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Architectural Design

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3D Architectural Viz

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Construction Drawings

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Design Permits & Planning

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BIM Coordination

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Concept Design

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Space Planning

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3D & ANIMATION SOFTWARE

Blender
Autodesk Maya
ZBrush
Cinema 4D
3ds Max
Houdini (FX)
3D Substance Painter
Substance Designer

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Samuel Latona is a multidisciplinary creative professional combining over 7 years of expertise across architectural design and 3D digital production. He operates at the rare intersection of technical architecture and high-end visual storytelling an increasingly valued skill set in a world where built-environment proposals, game development, product innovation, and digital media all demand photorealistic, emotionally resonant 3D communication.

As an Architect, Samuel specialises in full-cycle design delivery: from schematic concept through to technical construction documentation, planning permit submissions, and BIM-coordinated drawing packages. He has successfully managed residential, commercial, and mixed-use briefs, collaborating with structural and MEP engineers to ensure coherent, buildable solutions aligned with local regulatory frameworks. His designs are underpinned by a rigorous understanding of spatial quality, material logic, and human-centred design principles.

As a 3D Generalist, Samuel brings productions to life across product design, character animation, game trailer development, and cinematic visual effects. He is proficient in the full 3D pipeline modelling, rigging, texturing, shading, lighting, simulation, rendering, and compositing using an industry-leading toolkit that includes Blender, Maya, ZBrush, Cinema 4D, 3ds Max, Unreal Engine 5, V-Ray, and Substance Painter. His architectural background amplifies his 3D work: his spatial intuition, lighting knowledge, and eye for proportion elevate every scene he touches.

His architectural visualisation practice bridges both worlds deploying real-time engines (Unreal Engine 5, Enscape, Twinmotion) and offline renderers (V-Ray, Corona, Lumion) to produce immersive walk-throughs, photorealistic stills, and interactive presentations that consistently exceed client expectations. Samuel has contributed to projects across the United States, Turkey, Saudi Arabia, and Nigeria, demonstrating consistent quality standards and cross-cultural professional effectiveness.

Samuel is a disciplined self-starter, a collaborative team member, and a committed creative who brings measurable value to every project whether refining a character rig for a AAA game studio, producing a permit-ready drawing package for a developer, or delivering a cinematic product animation for a global brand.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SAMUEL LATONA ARCHITECTURE & DESIGN STUDIO

Principal Architect & 3D Visualization Director | Lagos, Nigeria (Remote International Projects)

January 2019 – Present

- Lead end-to-end architectural design commissions spanning residential, commercial, hospitality, and mixed-use typologies, managing projects from initial brief and concept design through to technical documentation, planning submission, and construction oversight.
- Produce full permit-ready drawing packages including site analysis, floor plans, roof plans, building elevations, cross-sections, site sections, drainage layouts, and large-scale construction details in compliance with local planning authority requirements.

Marvelous Designer
Unity (Real-Time)
Unreal Engine 5
V-Ray
Corona Renderer
Arnold Renderer
Octane Render
Adobe After Effects
DaVinci Resolve

ARCHITECTURAL SOFTWARE

Autodesk Revit (BIM)
AutoCAD
ArchiCAD
SketchUp Pro
Rhino 3D
Grasshopper (Parametric)
Lumion
Enscape
Twinmotion
Adobe Photoshop
Adobe InDesign
Adobe Illustrator
Microsoft Office Suite

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Autodesk Revit – Professional Use
Unreal Engine 5 – Real-Time Arch Viz
3D Animation & VFX – Advanced
BIM Coordination & Management

- Developed and implemented a BIM-first studio workflow using Autodesk Revit, reducing design-to-documentation cycle times by 35% and virtually eliminating coordination errors between architectural, structural, and MEP disciplines.
- Deliver photorealistic 3D architectural visualisations and real-time walk-throughs using Unreal Engine 5, Enscape, Lumion, V-Ray, and Corona consistently used by clients to accelerate design approvals and secure development funding.
- Prepared and submitted planning permission applications and building regulation applications, achieving 100% first-submission approval rate through meticulous compliance documentation and proactive liaison with planning officers.
- Conducted space planning, interior design coordination, and furniture layout studies, ensuring schemes achieve optimal livability, accessibility, and aesthetic quality.
- Built parametric design tools in Grasshopper and Rhino 3D to explore facade geometries, daylight optimisation, and structural efficiencies for complex building envelopes.
- Managed client relationships from inception to handover, providing regular design reviews, cost-efficiency analysis, and design iteration cycles tailored to project brief evolution.

CANOVATION MARKETING

Senior Product Designer & 3D Animator | Florida, United States (Remote)
October 2022 – Present

- Delivered high-fidelity 3D product design and animation solutions for a diverse portfolio of consumer and industrial clients, translating complex briefs into visually compelling, commercially effective digital assets.
- Designed and animated product launch visuals, explainer animations, and interactive product configurators used across digital marketing campaigns, reaching audiences of over 500,000+ users.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams including brand strategists, UX designers, and engineers to conceptualise, prototype, and refine products from ideation through to production-ready design specifications.
- Launched a customer-driven iterative design review process that reduced feedback loops by 40%, improving both team efficiency and client satisfaction scores.
- Created cost-optimised designs leveraging high-volume manufacturing processes and strategic material selection, delivering solutions 20–30% below initial budget projections without compromising quality.
- Consulted with the marketing department on product upgrades, identified failure points in service delivery, and developed data-informed remediation strategies.

FORWARDONTICS

3D Product Design & Animation Specialist | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)
October 2022 – Present

- Designed and produced detailed 3D models and full-cycle product animations for a medical-technology client operating in the orthodontics sector, requiring extreme precision and anatomical accuracy.
- Collaborated closely with engineering and clinical teams to verify design changes against functional and regulatory requirements, ensuring all deliverables met ISO-compliant product design standards.
- Drove a continuous improvement culture within the design team: standardised documentation templates, improved annotation protocols, and reduced engineering change order cycle time by 25%.
- Produced comprehensive technical documentation including product design specifications, assembly sequences, and annotated engineering drawings suitable for manufacturing and regulatory submission.
- Identified and developed three new product features based on direct user-research synthesis, each of which were adopted into the commercial product roadmap.
- Delivered full product animation and explanatory video content used in clinical training programmes and investor presentations across 12 countries.

ARCVISION DESIGN CONSULTANTS

Project Architect – Urban Residential & Commercial | Abuja, Nigeria

March 2020 – December 2022

- Designed and delivered a 48-unit mixed-income residential development in Abuja, managing full architectural documentation from RIBA Stage 1 through to Stage 4 Technical Design, inclusive of all statutory submissions.
- Produced detailed construction drawing sets structural grid plans, reflected ceiling plans, stair and ramp details, facade system drawings, and fire strategy plans coordinated across all engineering disciplines using BIM.
- Performed regulatory compliance reviews against the National Building Code of Nigeria and local planning authority guidelines, preparing schedule of accommodation reports, planning justification statements, and access statements.
- Coordinated with quantity surveyors on material specifications and value engineering exercises, achieving 15% reduction in superstructure costs while maintaining design integrity.
- Led client-facing design presentations, producing high-resolution rendered imagery, 3D walk-through videos, and physical study models to support design sign-off at each project stage.
- Supervised construction site visits, reviewed contractor submissions, responded to requests for information (RFIs), and issued architectural instructions (AIs) to maintain design quality on site.

LEXIS

Lead 3D Artist – Game Trailer Production | Texas, United States (Remote)

January 2023 – April 2023

- Served as lead 3D artist on a high-production-value cinematic game trailer, responsible for full creative and technical oversight of the 3D pipeline from concept art brief to final composited deliverable.
- Developed an intricate period-accurate Knight character model with fully rigged anatomy, cloth simulation, and custom shader networks built in ZBrush, Maya, and Substance Painter.
- Constructed large-scale environmental 3D sets including a historically referenced castle complex, atmospheric landscape terrain, and dynamic lighting rigs to achieve cinematic realism.
- Integrated VFX systems (particle simulations, volumetric fog, fire, and destruction effects) and SFX sync points, delivering a 90-second trailer asset that met the client's marketing campaign deadlines.

JH PRODUCTIONS

3D Generalist – Game Trailer Production | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia (Remote)

June 2021 – November 2021

- Contributed to a full 3D game trailer production for a AAA-style fantasy game title, working across character design, environment creation, and cinematic animation within a tight six-month production schedule.
- Produced a fully rigged and textured protagonist character model to broadcast-quality standards, with a complete LOD hierarchy suitable for both cinematic rendering and real-time game engine deployment.
- Created expansive 3D world-building assets stone architecture, natural environments, and atmospheric lighting referencing historical and cultural design precedents for authenticity.
- Collaborated with the audio team to choreograph animation to SFX and musical score, delivering a coherent and emotionally impactful final trailer.